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Dubai tops global FDI rankings

DUBAI
BY KHITAM AL AMIR
Chief News Editor

Dubai has topped the world's cities in attracting new foreign direct investment (FDI) projects during the first half of 2025, according to data from *Financial Times* – fDi Markets, drawing 643 high-quality projects – 478 more than the second-placed city, and the highest number ever recorded for any city globally in a half-year period since fDi Markets began tracking the data in 2003.

Shaikh Hamdan Bin Mohammed Bin Rashid Al Maktoum, Crown Prince of Dubai, Deputy Prime Minister and Minister of Defence of the UAE, and Chairman of the Dubai Executive Council, announced the news on his X account. “We take pride in the renewed confidence of international investors, reflecting the strength of our investment environment, the transparency of our regulations, the efficiency of our infrastructure, and our unique ability to adapt to shifts in the global economy,” Shaikh Hamdan said.

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France to recognise Palestine as UN summit gets under way

MACRON HOSTS MEETING WITH SAUDI CROWN PRINCE ON TWO-STATE SOLUTION

UNITED NATIONS

France and other countries prepared to recognise a Palestinian state as the UN's centrepiece diplomatic week got under way yesterday, following a rash of Western governments in symbolically endorsing statehood and sparking Israel's wrath.

Recognition by Britain, Canada, Australia and Portugal on Sunday of a Palestinian state piled pressure on Israel as it intensifies its war in Gaza, which has killed tens of thousands, devastated the enclave and drawn vocal rebukes from its allies.

President Emmanuel Macron said France will follow suit as he prepares to host a meeting with Saudi Arabia's Crown Prince Mohammed Bin Salman on the moribund two-state solution – Palestinian and Israeli coexistence.

“They want a nation, they want a state, and we should not push them towards Hamas,” Macron said Sunday, adding that the move would help isolate the armed group. He also said he would make the release of hostages taken by Hamas a



■ The Palestinian state flag flies at the City Hall of Nantes yesterday, the day of France's planned recognition of a Palestinian state at the United Nations.

AFP

precondition of opening an embassy to the Palestinian state. Israel's foreign ministry said the recognition moves do not “promote peace, but on the contrary further destabilises the region and undermines the chances of achieving a peaceful solution.”

More than 140 world leaders

will descend on New York this week for the annual United Nations General Assembly, which will be dominated by the Palestinian question. One leader who will miss it is Mahmoud Abbas, the Palestinian president whom Washington denied a visa, along with his officials.

Meanwhile, tens of thousands of people protested yesterday across Italy as part of a day of action to “denounce the genocide in Gaza”, with blockades, strikes and marches that descended into clashes with police in Milan.

— AFP

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